

# Numerical Methods for Non-Linear Mechanics

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## 1 Introduction

This short report presents the code that is assigned for the subject "Numerical Methods for Non-Linear Mechanics" of the Master Program for Civil Engineering, taught by professor Stefano-Dal Pont at Laboratory 3SR, University Grenoble Alpes, France. The object of the course is studying the non-linear problems in mechanics, caused by both the geometric and material behavior. The assignment practice therefore is to build in the most general form of the constitutive law, which is not linearity. 2 main problems are taken into account: A console problem in 2D and a Truss problem in 3D, so the remaining of this report is divided into two sections of the former subject. Besides, this is a ideal chance to practice, so I also try to provide a solution for the problem of Finite Element Method in 1D and 2D. The main code is actually written in `C++`, with libraries mostly building from scratch. They have been uploaded to [Github](#), the link to download is provided in section 6. Any corrections and comments are highly appreciated. I would like to thank the professors for letting me, even though being a PhD student, could join this program to learn. I really appreciated and enjoyed the class.

## 2 Theory

The following problem was fully described in lecture course [1] of professor [DAL-PONT](#).

### 2.1 Console

The whole geometry is described in fig. 1. Briefly speaking, the simple truss structure composed by 3 nodes linked by 2 bars and external force  $F$  applied on the node  $C$  making an angle  $\theta$  with the vertical axis, causing the displacement of the bars and nodes. Gravity is not taken into account. In this case,  $\vec{x}$  representing position of node  $C$  is considered as the main unknown, owing to the fact that it is the only free node and fully represents the equilibrium position of the system.  $\vec{e}^b$  is the unit vector of the corresponding bar  $b$ , which is calculated by the position vector of the node where the bar  $b$  begins ( $\vec{x}^B$ ) and ends ( $\vec{x}^E$ ):

$$\vec{b} = \vec{x}^{E(b)} - \vec{x}^{O(b)} \quad (2.1a)$$

$$l^b = \|\vec{b}\| \quad (2.1b)$$

$$\vec{e}^b = \frac{\vec{b}}{l^b} \quad (2.1c)$$

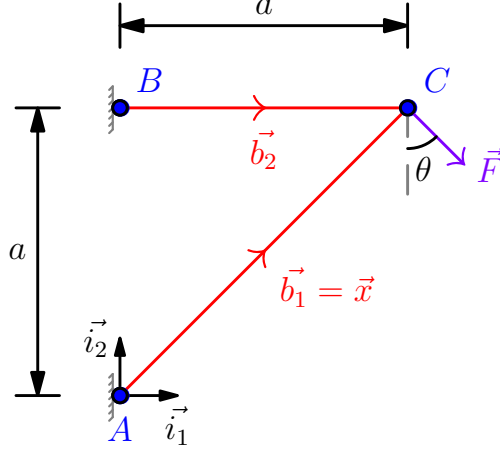


Figure 1: Two elements truss: console 2D

In truss elements, the only internal effort considered is the axial stress and further, also is a constant. To satisfy the nodal equilibrium, at position  $C$  the sum of the internal force (left-hand side) and the external force (right-hand side) must be balanced:

$$\sum_{b=1}^2 N^b = N^1 + N^2 = F \quad (2.2)$$

which  $N^b$  denotes this component that the right part exerts on the left part of bar  $b$ , which is assumed to depend only on the length of bar  $l^b$  via the constitutive law:

$$N^b = \mathcal{A}^b(l^b) \quad (2.3)$$

In case of large displacement, this relation is no longer linear, as the length of the bar changed accordingly with the new position of the node, in our case is node  $C$ . The following constitutive laws may be considered:

- Linear law:

$$\mathcal{A}^b(l^b) = \alpha^b \frac{l^b - l_0^b}{l_0^b} \quad (2.4)$$

- Saint-Venant Kirchhoff law:

$$\mathcal{A}^b(l^b) = \alpha^b \frac{(l^b)^2 - (l_0^b)^2}{2(l_0^b)^2} \quad (2.5)$$

- Logarithmic law:

$$\mathcal{A}^b(l^b) = \alpha^b \ln\left(\frac{l^b}{l_0^b}\right) \quad (2.6)$$

So in general form, the problem of the console could be written as follows:

$$\text{Given the force } \vec{F}, \quad (2.7)$$

$$\text{Find the position } \vec{x} \text{ of node C such that,} \quad (2.8)$$

$$-\mathcal{A}^1(l^1(\vec{x}))\hat{e}^1(\vec{x}) - \mathcal{A}^2(l^2(\vec{x}))\hat{e}^2(\vec{x}) + \vec{F} = \vec{0} \quad (2.9)$$

This problem is solved by Newton's iterative method in vector form for solving systems of equations. For the order-one truncated Taylor series expansion, expression at the iteration  $(k+1)$  shall be:

$$\underline{\underline{\nabla \mathcal{F}}}(\underline{x}^{(k)})\delta(\underline{x}^{(k)}) = -\underline{\mathcal{F}}(\underline{x}^{(k)}) \quad (2.10)$$

Solving the linear system get us the new value of  $\delta x$ , so we could update the position for the next iteration by:

$$\underline{x}^{(k+1)} = \underline{x}^{(k)} + \delta \underline{x}^{(k)} \quad (2.11)$$

Apply to the console problem eq. (2.10) becomes The method requires a stopping criterion: eq. (2.12) is chosen to be implemented in the code, as it satisfies the force equilibrium condition at nodes of the problem.

$$|f(x^{(k)})| < \epsilon \quad (2.12)$$

As  $\epsilon$  is a number small enough to be considered as 0, relatively to the problem solving. The object is now to transform equation eq. (2.3) into a linear form eq. (2.10) so that it could be numerically solved. Thanks to first-order Taylor expansion again, we obtain the development of sum of the force, which should be approaching 0, at iteration  $k+1$  (or in another word, at when node  $\mathbf{C}$  would take an increment in position into  $\vec{x} + \delta \vec{x}$ ):

$$\vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x} + \delta \vec{x}) = \vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}) + \left( \nabla \vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}) \right) @ \delta \vec{x} = 0 \quad (2.13)$$

where the Jacobian matrix  $\nabla \vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x})$  is described in the following equation using Einstein's sum notation:

$$\nabla \vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}) = -\frac{d\mathcal{A}^i}{dl^i} (\vec{e}^i(\vec{x}) \otimes \vec{e}^i(\vec{x})) - \frac{\mathcal{A}^i(l^i(\vec{x}))}{l^i(\vec{x})} (\mathbb{I} - \vec{e}^i(\vec{x}) \otimes \vec{e}^i(\vec{x})) \quad (2.14)$$

Finally, we can solve the system using a single linear vector equation, which is suitable to be implemented into computational calculating:

$$\left( \nabla \vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}^k) \right) @ \delta \vec{x}^k = -\vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}^k) \quad (2.15)$$

The first iteration starts from the initial condition of the system, then the iteration begins, until  $\vec{\mathcal{F}}(\vec{x}^k) < \epsilon$  to be considered null, as discussed above.

## 2.2 Truss

Similarly in the previous problem, each bar's geometry is fully accessible through the position of nodes. Their vectors could be determined totally similar in the previous problem via eq. (2.1). The problem of the small deformation truss can be stated as:

$$\text{Given the external force } \vec{F}^{e/n}, n \in \mathcal{N}_F \text{ and } \vec{U}^n, n \in \mathcal{N}_I \quad (2.16)$$

$$\text{find the displacement vector } \vec{u}^n, n \in \mathcal{N} \text{ so that } \vec{u}^n = \vec{U}^n, n \in \mathcal{N}_I \text{ and} \quad (2.17)$$

$$\forall \vec{v}^n \text{ such that } \vec{v}^n = 0, n \in \mathcal{N}_I \quad (2.18)$$

$$\sum_{b \in \mathcal{B}} k^b \vec{e}_0^b (\vec{u}^{E(b)} - \vec{u}^{O(b)}) \vec{e}_0^b (\vec{u}^{E(b)} - \vec{u}^{O(b)}) = \sum_{n \in \mathcal{N}_F} \vec{F}^{e/n} \vec{v}^n \quad (2.19)$$

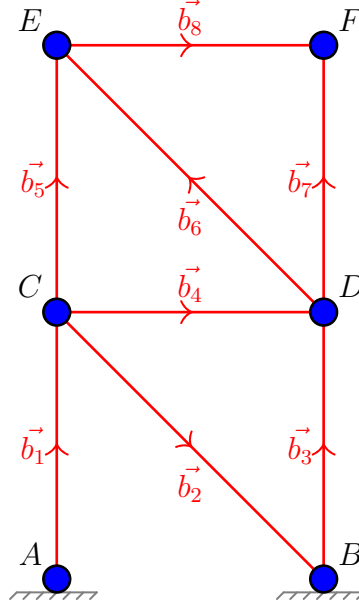


Figure 2: 3D truss

which expressed in matrix notation as:

$$\forall \underline{\mathcal{V}}^t \underline{\mathcal{K}} \underline{\mathcal{U}} = \underline{\mathcal{V}}^t \underline{\mathcal{F}} \quad (2.20)$$

or in the simplest way:

$$\underline{\mathcal{K}} \underline{\mathcal{U}} = \underline{\mathcal{F}} \quad (2.21)$$

We can easily verify that:

$$\underline{\mathcal{F}} = \begin{bmatrix} F_1^{e/1} \\ F_2^{e/1} \\ F_3^{e/1} \\ \vdots \\ F_1^{e/N} \\ F_2^{e/N} \\ F_3^{e/N} \end{bmatrix} ; \quad \underline{\mathcal{U}} = \begin{bmatrix} u_1^1 \\ u_2^1 \\ u_3^1 \\ \vdots \\ u_1^N \\ u_2^N \\ u_3^N \end{bmatrix} \quad (2.22)$$

Within each component the subscript  $k = 1, 2, 3$  stands for the 3 directions in 3D and the superscript  $n = 1..N$  determines indices of nodes.

Meanwhile, the global stiffness matrix  $\underline{\mathcal{K}}$  could be assembled by multiple methods. One of them is by using the elementary application  $K^b$  of bar  $b$  along with the connectivity matrix  $\underline{\underline{C}}^n$  as followed:

$$\underline{\mathcal{K}} = \sum_{b \in \mathcal{B}} \left( \underline{\underline{C}}^{E(b)} - \underline{\underline{C}}^{O(b)} \right) \underline{\underline{K}}^b \left( \underline{\underline{C}}^{E(b)} - \underline{\underline{C}}^{O(b)} \right) \quad (2.23)$$

$$\underline{\underline{C}}^n = \left[ \begin{array}{ccc|ccc|ccc} 0 & \cdots & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & 0 & 1 & 0 & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \end{array} \right] \quad (2.24)$$

$$\underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}}_{3(n_1)} \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}}_3 \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}}_{3(N_n)} \quad (2.25)$$

Though this method is easily implemented in coding small problem, when calculating manually by hand, we prefer using the elementary stiffness matrix

$$\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}^b = \underline{\underline{K}}^b \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (2.26)$$

At this point,  $\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}$  should be singular i.e  $\det(\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}) = 0$  because the kinematic boundary condition is not yet applied. Two different techniques are usually proposed: the direct method and the approximated method (so-called penalization method). The approximated is obtained by adding  $1/\epsilon$  to the main diagonal terms of  $\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}$  which corresponds to the nodes of  $\mathcal{N}_I$ :

$$\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}^\epsilon_{ii} = \underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}}_{ii} + \frac{1}{\epsilon}; i = 3(n-1) + k; n \in \mathcal{N}_I, k = 1, 2, 3 \quad (2.27)$$

## 2.3 Hardening

## 2.4 FEM1D

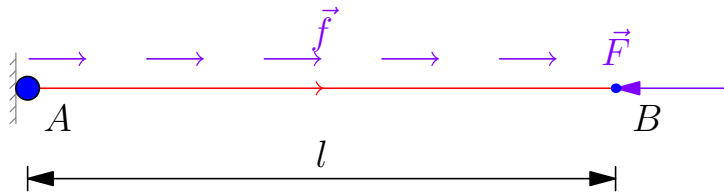


Figure 3: 1D Finite Element

The equilibrium equations therefore, described in the strong form:

$$\frac{dN}{dx} + f = 0; \quad (2.28a)$$

$$N(0) = -R; \quad (2.28b)$$

$$N(l) = F; \quad (2.28c)$$

$$N = EA \frac{du}{dx}; \quad (2.28d)$$

$$u(0) = 0; \quad (2.28e)$$

The weak form is expressed by;

$$\forall v \in V, \int_0^l EA \frac{du}{dx} \frac{dv}{dx} dx - Rv(0) = \int_0^l f v dx + Fv(l) \quad (2.29)$$

$$\forall v \in V, a(u, v) + b(R, v) = L(v) \quad (2.30)$$

rewritten in tensor notation:

$$\text{Find } \underline{\underline{U}} \text{ and } \mathcal{R} \text{ such that:} \quad (2.31)$$

$$U^1 = 0; \quad (2.32)$$

$$\underline{\underline{\mathcal{K}}} \underline{\underline{U}} + \mathcal{R} = \underline{\underline{\mathcal{F}}} \quad (2.33)$$

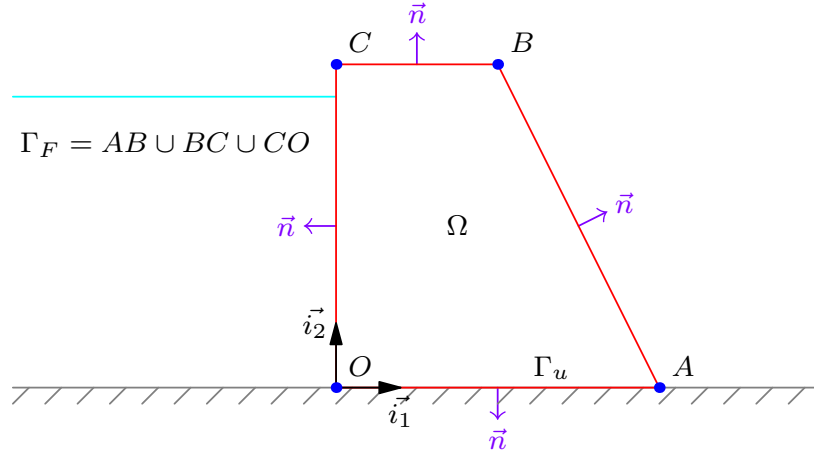


Figure 4: 2D Finite Element

## 2.5 FEM2D

$$\forall \vec{x} \in \Omega, \operatorname{div} \sigma + \vec{f} = 0; \quad (2.34)$$

$$\forall \vec{x} \in \Omega, \sigma = \lambda \operatorname{tr} \epsilon(\vec{u}) \mathbb{I} + 2\mu \epsilon(\vec{u}); \quad (2.35)$$

$$\forall \vec{x} \in \Gamma_u, \vec{u} = \vec{U}; \quad (2.36)$$

$$\forall \vec{x} \in \Gamma_F, \sigma @ \vec{n} = \vec{F}; \quad (2.37)$$

$$\forall \vec{x} \in \Gamma_u, \sigma @ \vec{n} = \vec{R}; \quad (2.38)$$

$$(2.39)$$

weak form:

$$\text{Find } \vec{u} \in V_0 \text{ and } \vec{\mathcal{R}} \text{ such that:} \quad (2.40)$$

$$\forall \vec{v} \in V, \int_{\Omega} (\lambda \operatorname{tr} \epsilon(\vec{u}) \operatorname{tr} \epsilon(\vec{v}) + 2\mu \epsilon(\vec{u}) : \epsilon(\vec{v})) ds - \int_{\Gamma_u} \vec{R} \vec{v} dl = \int_{\Omega} \vec{f} \vec{v} ds + \int_{\Gamma_F} \vec{F} \vec{v} dl; \quad (2.41)$$

## 3 Validation

### 3.1 Console

### 3.2 Truss

### 3.3 FEM1D

### 3.4 FEM2D

## 4 Application

### 4.1 Console

### 4.2 Truss

### 4.3 FEM1D

### 4.4 FEM2D

## 5 Conclusion

## 6 Annexxe

This part just provided the main code. Full version could be download in this [link](#).

## References

- [1] DAL-PONT, S. (2020). *Numerical Methods for Non-Linear Mechanics*. Université Grenoble Alpes, Grenoble, France. [1](#)